Study Guide & Topics for the Second Trimester English Evaluation – 1st Baccalaureate

TOPIC 1: VOCABULARY

1. Cinema, Press & Media Terminology

- **What to review:** Words related to movie production, journalism, and modern media (e.g., *stunt, prop, headline, byline, state-of-the-art, social media*).
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Circle the correct option:

"The actor refused to perform the dangerous motorbike _____ (prop / stunt) without a safety harness."

(Answer: stunt)

2. Weather, Climate & Environmental Issues

- **What to review:** Weather phenomena and environmental challenges (e.g., *downpour, drizzle, drought, damage, polar ice caps, facing nature*).
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Fill in the blank with the correct word:

"After four months without rain, the region suffered a catastrophic _____ that affected all local crops."

(Answer: drought)

3. Phrasal Verbs & Expressions

- **What to review:** Multi-word verbs and common expressions used in social and cultural contexts (e.g., *dress up as*, *pick up*).
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Complete the sentence:

"For the carnival parade, the children decided to _____ as historical figures."

(Answer: dress up)

TOPIC 2: GRAMMAR

1. Narrative Tenses: Past Simple vs. Past Perfect Simple

- **What to review:** Understanding the order of past events. We use the **Past Simple** for completed past actions and chronological events, and the **Past Perfect Simple** (*had + past participle*) for an action that happened *before* another past event.

- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Circle the correct verb form:

"When we arrived at the boarding gate, the airplane _____ (already took off / had already taken off)."

(Answer: had already taken off)

2. The Passive Voice (Present Simple & Past Simple)

- **What to review:** Shifting focus from the doer of the action to the action/object itself.
    - Present Simple Passive: *am / is / are + past participle*
    - Past Simple Passive: *was / were + past participle*
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Rewrite the sentence in the passive voice:

Active: "A famous architect built this museum in 1995."

Passive: "This museum _____ by a famous architect in 1995."

(Answer: was built)

3. Modal Verbs: Advice, Strong Warnings & Possibility

- **What to review:**
    - Possibility: *might / might not*
    - Advice / Recommendations: *should / shouldn't*
    - Strong warnings & urgent recommendations with consequences: *had better / had better not*
    - Past inability: *couldn't*
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Choose the correct modal verb:

"You _____ (had better / couldn't) put on sunscreen immediately, or your skin will get burned."

(Answer: had better)

4. Expressing Wishes & Regrets about Present Situations (*Wish / If only*)

- **What to review:** Using *I wish* or *If only* followed by the **Past Simple** to express a desire for a current situation to be different.
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Rewrite the sentence using the prompt word:

"People throw plastic into the rivers."

If only: "If only people _____ plastic into the rivers."

(Answer: didn't throw)

5. Order of Adjectives & Post-Modifiers

- **What to review:** The correct standard order when multiple adjectives describe a noun (e.g., *Opinion → Size → Age → Colour → Origin → Material → Purpose + Noun*), followed by relative clauses or prepositional phrases.
- **Sample Practice:**
    - *Exercise:* Put the words in the correct order:

Italian / leather / lovely / jacket / that my father bought / brown

(Answer: The lovely brown Italian leather jacket that my father bought)

TOPIC 3: READING COMPREHENSION

- **What to review:**
    - Reading informal emails/letters.
    - Identifying key information, specific details, and contextual vocabulary (topics: university life, journalism, climate activism, film projects).
    - True/False statements with mandatory corrections of false statements using text evidence.
- **Sample Practice:**
    - Read short articles about media, climate change, or filmmaking and practice identifying whether factual statements are true or false, providing written corrections for inaccurate statements.

TOPIC 4: WRITING

- **Task:** Writing a **Film Review** (~150 words).
- **What to review:**
    - **Structure:**
        1. *Introduction:* Film title, genre, director, main cast.
        2. *Plot Summary:* Setting and premise (without giving away spoilers).
        3. *Critique:* Evaluation of characters, acting, cinematography, soundtrack, special effects (positive and negative aspects).

4. *Conclusion & Recommendation:* Final verdict and who would enjoy this movie.

- **Assessment Criteria (0.25 pt each / Total: 1.0 pt):**
  - *Content:* Addresses all required elements (plot, characters, critique, recommendation).
  - *Grammar:* Accurate use of target structures (passive voice, narrative tenses, adjectives).
  - *Vocabulary:* Rich, varied, and appropriate film/media terminology.
  - *Spelling & Punctuation:* Clear mechanics and neat formatting.

General Exam Guidelines & Recommendations

- **Materials:** Black or blue pen only (pencil is not permitted).
- **Accuracy:** No erasures, liquid paper, or crossed-out answers in objective sections, as these invalidate the question.
- **Study Routine:** Practice writing out full sentences and reviewing irregular past participle forms.